CARGOLANE · USER MANUAL

Sales

You own the enquiry from the moment it arrives until it is won or lost.

> Read **Getting started** first.

What you hold

Everything from enquiry to award, and nothing operational.

YOU CAN	YOU CANNOT
Create, assign and price enquiries	Book or update a shipment
Send and revise quotations	Touch customs, documents or free time
Accept and reject quotations	Add or change a rate card
Close an enquiry won, lost or cancelled	Add an agent, haulier or carrier
Create and edit customers and contacts	Anything on an invoice or receipt
Read shipments — see what you sold, running	
Read the dashboards, the margin report, and export them	

The two in bold are yours and not the coordinator's. You decide what was won and what was lost, because that is the number you are measured on and it is not a number an administrator should be setting for you.

The queue

Commercial → Enquiries. Every enquiry in every branch you work in — by email, from the portal, by phone or walk-in. Mail to a mailbox your administrator has connected becomes an enquiry for that branch within a minute, already in the queue and marked unassigned; mail that quotes one of your own references joins that enquiry or job instead of opening a new one.

What the assistant read off the email

If document extraction is switched on, an emailed enquiry opens with a panel headed **Read from the email**: mode, direction, origin, destination, commodity, Incoterm, cargo-ready date, gross weight, volume, pieces, dimensions and dangerous goods — each as the assistant read it, with the line of the mail it was read from quoted beside it, and the model's confidence.

Accept writes the value onto the enquiry, under your own name in the audit trail. **Dismiss** discards it. Nothing touches the enquiry until you decide, and a person's typing always wins: a proposal flagged **Already filled** is one whose field somebody has since typed into, and accepting it is refused rather than overwriting

them. A proposal with **No line quoted** has no evidence behind it — read the mail before accepting. Deciding needs the assign permission, so a coordinator can do this too.

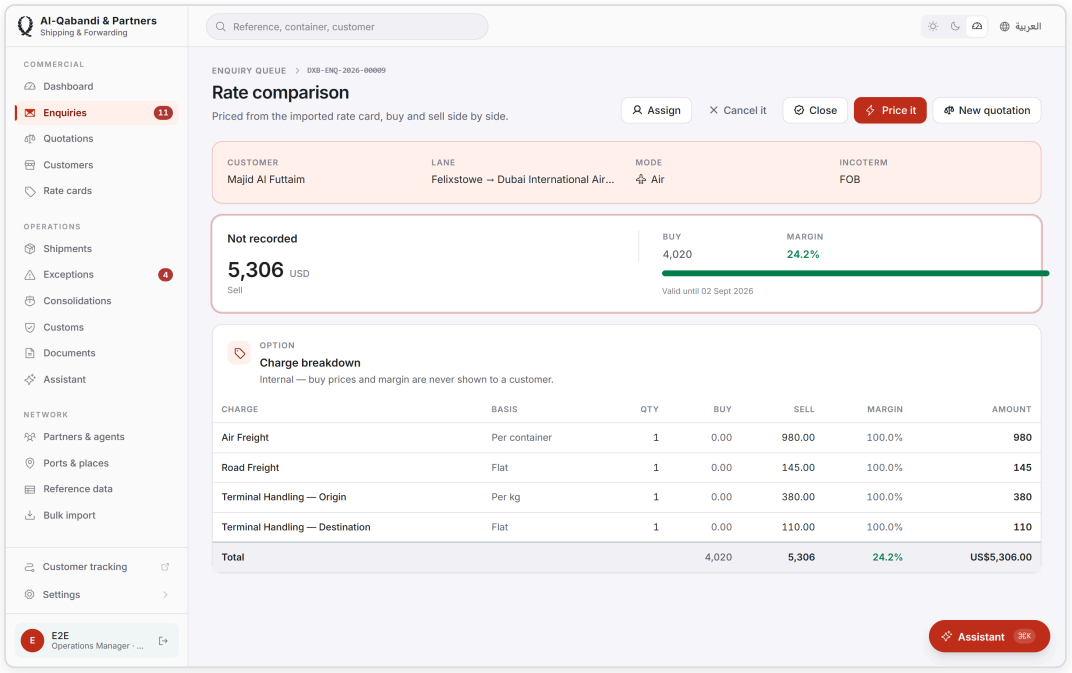
Two things matter about an enquiry beyond its content:

It has an owner. An enquiry with no owner has nobody's name against the clock. The queue flags unassigned ones. Assign them — to yourself if nobody else — before you do anything else in the morning.

It has a deadline, counted in working hours on your branch's calendar. The dashboard shows what has breached and what is due today, and the SLA watch list is ordered by whichever breaches soonest.

The clock stops when a quotation is sent, or when you press **Mark replied**. It does not stop because somebody opened the enquiry, and it does not stop on its own because you replied by email outside the system — which is the most common way a good response time is recorded as a breach. If you did answer outside the system, **Mark replied** records the time of that first reply; it cannot be undone. **Start rating** tells the queue somebody is on it and stops nothing.

Pricing



Rate comparison on an enquiry: buy, sell and margin side by side. The customer never sees the buy side.

Open the enquiry and press **Price it**. The system finds a live rate card for the lane, mode and date, calculates chargeable weight for the mode, and applies the accessorials from the catalogue.

The internal comparison

This is the screen that is worth learning properly. It shows every option with **buy, sell and margin side by side** — before the quotation goes out.

You are seeing the margin at the moment of quoting rather than at month-end. Two consequences worth internalising:

- **A thin margin is a decision, not an accident.** If you send it anyway, you did so knowingly, and that is a defensible answer when somebody asks later.

- **Discounting has a visible floor.** You can see what you are giving away as you give it.

When there is no rate

You will be told there is no live rate card for the lane rather than given a number that looks plausible. That means nobody has a buying rate on file and whatever you quote is from memory.

Tell your operations manager rather than working around it. The rate-card screen has a panel counting exactly these lanes, and yours is a data point that gets a contract negotiated.

The quotation

Sent on your letterhead, in Arabic or English, with your terms and a validity date. **PDF (EN)** and **PDF (AR)** on the quotation page render it; the branch's trading conditions print at the foot and its list of what is not included — duties, taxes, examination charges — prints beside the charges. Both are set per entity by your administrator, because Kuwait and Dubai do not share a footer.

Send it moves a draft to *Sent*; the margin is frozen at that moment and a later rate change does not alter it. **Accept** and **Reject** record the customer's answer.

Revising supersedes. The previous version is marked superseded and stays readable — so when a customer says "your first price was lower", the first price is still there, exactly as sent. Revise rather than editing, always.

Validity expires on its own. A quotation past its validity moves to expired without anyone touching it, which is what stops a customer accepting a March price in September.

Closing

You close the enquiry, and how you close it is the data. **Close** asks how it ended; **Cancel it** is a separate button, for one that will not be quoted at all.

CLOSE IT AS	WHEN
Won	The customer accepted. Accept the quotation too — that is what carries the agreed rates onto the job file, so what was sold is what gets costed.
Lost	They went elsewhere, or did not proceed. The reason is required — it is the only place this answer gets recorded, and it is what tells you why you lose.
Cancelled	The cargo does not exist, it was a duplicate, or it was never real.

Lost and cancelled are not the same thing and the difference is worth protecting. Lost means you competed and did not win — that is a win-rate number and a pricing signal. Cancelled means there was nothing to win. A team that cancels its losses has a win rate that looks excellent and means nothing, and the first person misled by it is you.

Close the lost ones. An enquiry left open because the answer is disappointing sits in the queue, counts against the branch, and pollutes the response-time median. It costs more to leave it than to close it.

Customers

You can create and edit customers and their contacts.

Both names, every time. English and Arabic. The Arabic name is what appears on the Arabic quotation and in the Arabic portal — a customer record with only an English name produces a document that reads half-finished to the person you are trying to impress.

A real contact with a real email. It is what the portal invitation uses, and the portal is the thing that stops them ringing your coordinators.

What to watch on the dashboard

	READ IT AS
Median response	What your customers actually experience, enquiry to quotation. The median rather than the average, because averages hide the bad days.
Win rate	Quotes won against quotes sent this month.
Average margin	What you keep on a typical quotation, before overheads.
Enquiries received	Last fourteen days, against the previous week.
Busiest lanes	Where your volume actually is — often not where you think.

Read win rate and average margin together, always. Rising win rate with falling margin means the team is buying work. Falling win rate with rising margin may be exactly right. Either number alone will mislead you, and the dashboard puts them next to each other for that reason.

Finance → Reports is the margin report: shipments by the date they sailed, cut by branch, customer, trade lane, mode or salesperson, with revenue, cost, gross profit and margin. **Export CSV** takes it out whole.

Five habits

1. **Nothing stays unassigned overnight.** The clock runs regardless.
2. **Quote in the system, not from your mailbox.** A quotation sent by email outside the system is a breached SLA in the record and an argument you cannot win six months later.
3. **Revise, never edit.** What you sent is evidence.
4. **Close your losses honestly.** Lost is not cancelled.
5. **Report every lane with no rate card.** It is how the contract gets negotiated, and it is your margin next quarter.